

ALEJANDRO CARRANZA

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EDUCATION

University of California, San Diego (UCSD)

Ph.D. Experimental Psychology Expected 2028

M.A. Experimental Psychology March 2025

University of California, Los Angeles (UCLA)

BA Psychology June 2023
Summa Cum Laude

College of the Canyons

AA-T Psychology June 2021
Summa Cum Laude

RESEARCH INTERESTS

I'm interested in the cognitive mechanisms that underlie learning and memory. My current research focuses on retrieval practice, cognitive load, and metacognition. I'm specifically interested in the factors that can disrupt or aid these cognitive processes. I aim to apply my research to multimedia learning environments to enhance learning efficiency.

PUBLICATIONS

Carranza, A., Geller, E. H, & Rickard, T. C. (2024). Sorry! You lost me at restudy: The power of engagement during successive study. *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*, 46. Retrieved from <https://escholarship.org/uc/item/5ck6b3vj>

Carranza, A., & Geller, E. H. (2026). A redundant redundancy principle? examining the redundancy principle through cognitive load. *Educational Psychology*, 1–15. <https://doi.org/10.1080/01443410.2026.2678483>

PRESENTATIONS

Carranza, A., & Silaj, K. (2023, May). Revisiting Recall in Relation to Reward-Based Learning: An Investigation of the Testing Effect in Value-Directed Learning. Poster presented at the 32nd Annual UCLA Psychology Undergraduate Research Conference (PURC); May 12, 2023; Los Angeles, CA.

Carranza, A., Geller, E. H., & Rickard, T. C. (2024). *Sorry! You lost me at restudy: The power of engagement during successive study.* Poster presented at the 46th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society (CogSci); July 26, 2024; Rotterdam, NL.

Carranza, A., Geller, E. H., & Rickard, T. C. (2024). *Reevaluating Restudy vs. Testing: The Benefit of Semantic Engagement During Repeated Study.* Poster presented at the 65th Annual Psychonomic Society Meeting; November 22, 2024; New York, NY

HONORS AND AWARDS

<i>Norman H. Anderson Travel Grant</i>	2024
University of California, San Diego (UCSD)	

<i>Dean's Honors</i>	2021 - 2023
University of California, Los Angeles (UCLA)	

<i>Dean's List and Semester Honors</i>	2019 - 2021
College of the Canyons	

<i>Phi Rho Pi Bronze Medalist</i>	2021
National Speech Tournament, Informative and Impromptu speaking	

<i>Cougar Classic Gold Medalist</i>	2020
Informative Speaking	

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Learning and Instruction in Multimedia Environments Lab, UCSD	2023 - Current
<i>Principle Investigator:</i> Dr. Emma Geller	
<i>Role:</i> Graduate Student Researcher	

Cognition and Cognitive Neuroscience Lab, UCSD

2023 – Current

Principle Investigator: Dr. Timothy Rickard

Role: Graduate Student Researcher

Memory and Lifespan Cognition Lab, UCLA

2022 - 2023

Principle Investigator: Dr. Alan Castel

Role: Research Assistant

TRUST Lab, UCLA

2022 - 2023

Principle Investigator: Dr. Lauren Ng

Role: Research Assistant

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of California, San Diego

Teaching Assistant

PSYC 1. Psychology

PSYCH 3. General Psychology: Cognitive Foundations

PSYCH 70. Research Methods in Psychology

PSYC 106. Behavioral Neuroscience

PSYC 154. Behavior Modification

PSYC 162. Psychology and the Law

SPECIALIZED SKILLS & EXPERIENCE

Computer Skills: R, JavaScript, CSS, HTML, Qualtrics, MS Office

Certifications: Social and Behavioral Responsible Conduct of Research, Good Clinical Practices, & HIPAA certified

Languages: Fluent in English and Spanish